SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "CAHORS"

approved by decree no. 2009-1262 of 19 October 2009

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Cahors", initially recognised by the decree of 15 April 1971.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Cahors" is reserved for still red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Lot department: Albas, Anglars-Juillac, Arcambal, Bagat-en-Quercy, Bélaye, Le Boulvé, Cahors, Caillac, Cambayrac, Carnac-Rouffiac, Castelfranc, Catus, Cieurac, Crayssac, Douelle, Duravel, Fargues, Flaujac-Poujols, Floressas, Grézels, Labastide-du-Vert, Lacapelle-Cabanac, Lagardelle, Lamagdelaine, Luzech, Mauroux, Mercuès, Nuzéjouls, Parnac, Pescadoires, Pontcirq, Pradines, Prayssac, Puy-l'Évêque, Saint-Matré, Saint-Médard, Saint-Vincent-Rive-d'Olt, Saux, Sauzet, Sérignac, Soturac, Touzac, Trespoux-Rassiels, Villesèque, Vire-sur-Lot.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 16 February 1984 and of 5 and 6 June 2002. The National Institute of Origin and Quality will lodge with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes: Lot department: Labastide-Marnhac, Le Montat, Saint-Martin-le-Redon, Valroufié.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: cot N (also called malbec); - accessory varieties: merlot N and tannat N.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The proportion of the cot N variety is greater than or equal to 70 % of the grape varieties. The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed over all of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the appellation.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows of

2.50 metres maximum. The spacing between plants within the same row must be between 0.90 metre and 1.30 metres.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned: - either in goblet, in fan, or Royat cordon; each plant bearing at most 12 free eyes (buds) of which at most 2 free eyes per spur; - or by single or double Guyot pruning; each plant bearing at most 12 free eyes of which at most 2 free eyes per spur and 8 free eyes per long cane. Whatever the pruning technique used, the number of fruit-bearing shoots per plant, after flowering (phenological stage 23 of Lorenz), may not be greater than 12. The tannat N variety, whatever the pruning technique used, is pruned with a maximum of 8 free eyes per plant. The number of fruit-bearing shoots per plant, after flowering (phenological stage 23 of Lorenz), may not be greater than 8.

c) – Trellising rules (and foliage height).
For the vines trained according to the training mode known as "raised single-plane trellising", the height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,500 kilograms per hectare. When irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 644-23 of the Rural Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 644-22 of the Rural Code is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels must be managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils that constitute a fundamental element of the terroir, the headlands are grassed.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 644-23 of the Rural Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness. The date of the start of the harvest is fixed according to the provisions of Article D. 644-24 of the Rural Code.

b) – Particular harvest provisions. No particular provision.

c) – Particular provisions for the transport of the harvest. No particular provision.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar richness lower than 193 grams per litre of must may not be considered as being at proper ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11.5 %.

c) – Minimum acquired alcoholic strength by volume. No particular provision.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is fixed at 50 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is fixed at 60 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Maximum production yield

No particular provision.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the first year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the first year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

5° – Particular provisions

No particular provision.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing.
The destemming of the harvest is compulsory.

b) – Blending of the varieties.
The red wines arise from the cot N variety alone or from a blend presenting a minimum of 70 % of the cot N variety.

c) – Malolactic fermentation.
The malolactic fermentation is compulsory. The maximum malic acid content is fixed at 0.4 gram per litre on the lots ready to be marketed in bulk or packaged.

d) – Analytical standards.
Every lot of wine marketed in bulk or packaged presents: - a content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre for the lots of wine presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 14 %, and less than or equal to 4 grams per litre for the lots of wine presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 14 %; - a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 18.35 milliequivalents per litre, that is to say 1.09 gram per litre expressed in acetic acid (0.90 gram per litre of H2SO4); - a modified colouring intensity greater than or equal to 11 (sum of the optical densities at 420, 520 and 620 nanometres).

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
The subtractive enrichment techniques (SET) are authorised. The rate of partial concentration is fixed at 10 % maximum. The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %.

f) – Prohibited equipment.
No particular provision.

g) – Global capacity of the vinification and storage vat facility.
Every operator must have a global vat volume equivalent to 1.5 times the product of the area in production by the yield referred to in 1° of point VIII.

h) – Good overall upkeep of the cellar (floors and walls) and equipment (hygiene).
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

The wines are aged at least until 1 March of the year following the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator: - keeps available for the approved control body the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 644-36 of the Rural Code; - sends to the approved control body, in addition to its prior declaration of packaging or of transaction, an analysis carried out at most fifteen days before the lodging of this declaration. This analysis bears on the total alcoholic strength by volume, the parameters fixed in d of 1° of point IX of the present specification and the total sulphur dioxide content.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer. At the end of the ageing period, the wines may be placed on the market for the consumer only after 15 March of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers. The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 1 March of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the origin

1° – Descriptions of the factors of the link with the terroir

2° – Historical elements concerning the factors of the link with the terroir

3° – Historical elements linked to the reputation of the product

4° – Causal link between the geographical area, the quality and the characteristics of the product

XI. – Transitional measures

a) – The vines in place on 31 August 1992, not meeting the provisions relating to the planting density (planting density, spacings between rows and within the same row), continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2010 harvest inclusive.

b) – From the 2011 harvest, the vines in place on 31 August 1992, presenting a planting density greater than or equal to 4,000 plants per hectare but not meeting the provisions relating to the spacing between rows and to the spacing within the same row, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, under the following conditions: - the average maximum load per parcel is limited to 6,500 kilograms of grapes per hectare; - the limit yield is limited, over the area corresponding to these parcels, to 50 hectolitres per hectare.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Cahors” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered and accompanied by the entry “Appellation contrôlée”, the whole in very apparent characters.

2° – Particular provisions

No particular provision.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body before 25 November following the harvest. It indicates in particular: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the global vat volume; - the EVV and SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration or, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts, and by the general plan of the places of storage.

2. Prior declaration of parcel allocation

Each operator declares to the defence and management body the list of the parcels allocated to the production of the controlled designation of origin before 15 May preceding each harvest. This declaration specifies in particular: - the identity of the operator; - the EVV and SIRET number; - the cooperative cellar(s) to which it is, where applicable, a supplier; - for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the year of planting, the variety, the planting density, the spacings on the row and between rows; - date and signature of the operator. This declaration will distinguish the parcels for which the transitional measures provided for in point 11 of the present specification apply.

3. Prior declaration of transaction or of packaging. – Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator sends to the approved control body a prior declaration of transaction or of packaging for each lot of wine: - at the earliest four months before the date of the first removal or of the first packaging (bottling, bag-in-box…); - and at the latest thirteen days before the date of the first removal or of the first dispatch of a packaged lot. The renewal of this declaration must be made for the remaining volumes when the lot is not entirely removed or packaged within the four months following the date of the lodging of the prior declaration of transaction or of packaging. The non-packaged lot is defined as a homogeneous, blended whole, arising from one or more containers. For the non-packaged lots being the subject of a transaction, the operator specifies in its declaration whether the lot is intended to be dispatched non-packaged outside the national territory and completes its declaration by sending, to the approved control body, the results of the analysis of the lot considered bearing on the total alcoholic strength by volume, the parameters fixed in d of 1° of point IX of the present specification and the total sulphur dioxide content, carried out at most fifteen days before the lodging of the declaration and at the latest at the first removal.

4. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a time limit of one month maximum after this downgrading. This declaration indicates in particular: - the name of the appellation concerned; - the identity of the applicant; - the EVV and SIRET number; - the volume of wine downgraded; - the balance of volume remaining claimed in controlled designation of origin.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. Ripeness monitoring register

The keeping of a ripeness register is compulsory. It indicates the sugar content of the grapes of all the unit lots of harvest intended for the production of controlled designation of origin. By unit lot is meant every global load of a transport vehicle bringing the harvest to the place of vinification.

2. Blending register

The keeping of a blending register is compulsory. It specifies the composition of the lots (percentage of cot N, merlot N and tannat N) being the subject of a transaction or packaged.

CHAPTER III

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A.1. Belonging of the planted parcels within the delimited area.	Documentary (up-to-date CVI record) and in the field.
A.2. Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of any derogatory measures, planting density).	Documentary (prior declaration of parcel allocation) and visit in the field.
A.3. Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facility. — Place of vinification.	Documentary and on-site.
Traceability of the packaging.	Documentary (keeping of register) and on-site.
Place of storage demonstrated for the packaged products.	Documentary and on-site.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B.1. Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Check at the parcel.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check at the parcel by counting the bunches on 20 stocks distributed in 4 plots of 5 consecutive plants. Reinforced check for the vines benefiting from the transitional measures (b of point XI).
Irrigation.	Documentary (declaration obligations) and at the parcel (average maximum load per parcel).
B.2. Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Check of the register recording the sugar content of the unit lots of harvest. Reinforced check for the vines benefiting from the transitional measures (b of point XI).
Monitoring of the harvest date.	Verification of the derogations, field checks.
B.3. Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary and in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary (check of the declarations, monitoring of the authorised derogations). Reinforced check for the vines benefiting from the transitional measures (b of point XI).
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Wines ready to be marketed.	Analytical examination (including total sulphur dioxide) and organoleptic. Reinforced check for the wines arising from the holdings presenting vines benefiting from the transitional measures (b of point XI).
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.